UN. Having taken umbrage at the prices he was being charged at the Shelbourne Hotel, the Cuban Prime Minister went to stay at Hotel Theresa in Harlem, where he was visited by the African American human rights activist Malcolm X, and had meetings with Egyptian President Gamal Abdel Nasser and Indian Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru. Nikita Khrushchev also went to meet Fidel in Harlem where they met for the first time. The hug between the smiling (six feet three inch) Cuban Prime Minister and the beaming (five feet three inch) Soviet Premier provided an image that stirred many Americans' worst fears.

In his speech to the UN General Assembly, Castro referred to a remark by the US Chief of Naval Operations, Admiral Arleigh Burke, that the Soviets would never be so foolish to aid Cuba by launching rockets at the United States. Khrushchev raised his fist and shouted, 'He is mistaken!'[26] The Soviet Premier also addressed the General Assembly, though his presence was best remembered for interrupting the Philippines delegate by banging his shoe on the table. Theodore Roosevelt had famously advised, 'speak softly and carry a big stick.' Nikita Khrushchev offered instead: 'bellow loudly and carry a large shoe.'

Bay of Pigs *(Bahia de Cochinos)*

When Castro and his small band of followers fought Batista's army in the Sierra Maestra mountains after 1956, his male comrades became known as the *barbudos* (bearded ones). Over dinner, in March 1960, Ian Fleming, the creator of James Bond (and formerly of British naval intelligence), explained to Senator Kennedy how the Cuban revolution could be ended. Whether tongue in cheek or not, Fleming suggested dropping pamphlets across Cuba to warn that radioactivity from atomic testing lingered longest in beards and would make men impotent. Fleming opined that Cubans would shave off their beards. Without bearded revolutionaries, the revolution would collapse.[27]

One of Senator Kennedy's dinner guests was a CIA officer, who the following day imparted Fleming's 'insights' into Cuban machismo to the Director of Central Intelligence (DCI), Allen Dulles.[28] In fact, the CIA's